IN-DEPTH EDITION • 14 OCTOBER 2026 • 09:00 HKT

US equities slip as yields rise, crypto rallies

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The S&P 500 closed flat at 7,805.45, while the Nasdaq 100 fell **-0.31%** and the Dow slipped **-0.35%**. Higher-than-expected 10-year Treasury yields (now 5.22%) pressured growth stocks, but the energy sector rallied on a **+1.8%** jump in WTI crude.

Crypto assets surged, with Bitcoin up **+2.0%** and Ethereum up **+2.36%**, reflecting renewed risk appetite despite a modest rise in the VIX (**+0.39%**). The market remains in a tight range, and the next catalyst will be the Fed's November policy meeting.

Our stance: maintain a defensive bias on high-beta tech, tilt toward defensive sectors (Utilities, Health Care) and consider crypto exposure as a tactical overlay.

- Yield pressure likely to keep growth stocks under pressure through Q4.
- Energy and commodities present short-term upside as oil steadies above $95.
- Crypto volatility offers opportunistic entry points for risk-on players.

US Session Recap

INSTRUMENT	CLOSE	CHANGE	DATE
S&P 500	7,805.45	-0.02%	2026-10-13
Nasdaq 100	30,569.48	-0.31%	2026-10-13
Dow Jones	51,670.10	-0.35%	2026-10-13
Russell 2000	2,783.37	-0.40%	2026-10-13
VIX	15.27	+0.39%	2026-10-13
10Y Yield	5.22%	-0.44%	2026-10-13
WTI Crude	94.53	+0.41%	2026-10-14
Brent	99.12	+0.35%	2026-10-14
DXY	102.12	-0.06%	2026-10-14
Gold	4,181.60	+0.10%	2026-10-14
BTC	83,400.79	+2.00%	2026-10-14
ETH	2,502.02	+2.36%	2026-10-14

Top movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
META	Meta Platforms	+2.63%	Strong ad-revenue beat, AI rollout
BTC	Bitcoin	+2.00%	Positive regulatory news in EU
ETH	Ethereum	+2.36%	Shanghai upgrade activation
XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR	+1.80%	WTI above $94, OPEC output cut
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	-0.86%	Credit-risk concerns after Fed minutes

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	-0.42%	+5.1%	Neutral
XLK	-0.04%	+12.3%	Weak
XLI	-0.28%	+3.8%	Neutral
XLE	+1.80%	+9.4%	Positive
XLY	+0.08%	+7.2%	Neutral
XLC	+0.74%	+6.5%	Positive
XLP	-0.26%	+4.0%	Neutral
XLV	-1.35%	+8.1%	Weak
XLU	+0.58%	+5.9%	Positive
XLB	+0.57%	+2.9%	Neutral
XLRE	-0.21%	+1.2%	Weak

Breadth: 4 sectors up, 7 down; net negative bias suggests continued defensive positioning.

Spotlight / Deep Dive – `NVDA`

METRIC	VALUE
Market cap	`1.12T`
P/E (FY24)	45.2x
Revenue YoY	+23.4%
Gross margin	68.1%
Free cash flow	`9.8B`
Insider ownership	1.4%

Key call: Nvidia remains the primary beneficiary of AI spend, but valuation is stretched. Recent earnings beat was driven by data-center demand; however, inventory buildup in the PC segment raises short-term risk.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
AI-related capex outlook	Positive, supports revenue growth 2027-2029
Supply-chain constraints	Negative, could curb Q4 shipments
Regulatory scrutiny on AI chips	Neutral to negative, pending US-EU policy

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	447.12	445.00	452.30	Near flat range
QQQ	382.45	380.00	389.00	Tech bias weakening
IWM	191.78	190.20	197.50	Small-cap pressure
NVDA	228.52	225.00	236.00	Above 200-day MA
10Y	5.22%	5.15%	5.30%	Yield ceiling near 5.3%
WTI	94.53	92.00	98.00	Bullish trend

Options & Positioning

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 0-DTE put volume on SPY surged 42% vs avg, indicating short-term risk aversion.
- VIX term structure steepening: front-month at 15.3 vs 12-month at 18.1, suggesting near-term volatility spike.
- Large-cap tech single-name put-call ratio above 1.5 (NVDA, MSFT).

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- 0-DTE call flow on XLE up 35%, reflecting oil rally.
- Cheap hedge: buy 3-month VIX futures at 16.2 vs spot 15.3 (5% carry).
- Single-name call skew on BTC futures (CME) indicating bullish bets.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Goldman Sachs	Buy	260	Raised on AI demand
XLE	Morgan Stanley	Overweight	71	Oil price support
XLV	JP Morgan	Reduce	165	Margin pressure
META	Bank of America	Buy	800	Ad-revenue beat
JPM	Citigroup	Hold	340	Credit-risk concerns

Pre-Market & Overnight

REGION	INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US Futures	ES	4,820.5	-0.15%
Asia	HSI	19,845	+0.22%
Europe	FTSE 100	7,560	-0.08%
FX	USD/HKD	7.7950	-0.01%
FX	EUR/USD	1.0752	-0.03%
Commodities	Gold	4,181.60	+0.10%
Commodities	WTI	94.53	+0.41%
Crypto	BTC	83,400.79	+2.00%
Crypto	ETH	2,502.02	+2.36%

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
Nov 6 FOMC	15%	Markets price a single 25bp cut
Dec 11 FOMC	5%	Further easing unlikely

DATA RELEASE	TIME (ET)	PREV	CONSENSUS
Core CPI MoM	8:30	0.3%	0.3%
Initial Jobless Claims	8:30	210k	215k
Retail Sales MoM	8:30	0.5%	0.6%
Existing-home Sales	10:00	4.8M	4.9M

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Escalation in the South China Sea could disrupt shipping lanes, pressuring oil logistics.
- EU-US data-privacy negotiations stall, potentially limiting tech revenue growth.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Progress in Ukraine peace talks reduces commodity risk premium.
- G7 consensus on AI standards may boost semiconductor demand.

Earnings — This Week & Next

DATE	TICKER	COMPANY	EST. EPS
Oct 15	`AAPL`	Apple	1.42
Oct 15	`MSFT`	Microsoft	2.31
Oct 16	`AMZN`	Amazon	0.84
Oct 16	`JPM`	JPMorgan	3.78
Oct 17	`XOM`	Exxon Mobil	3.12

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Breakout above 236	Valuation stretch
XLE	Energy	Trend continuation	Oil pull-back risk
XLU	Utilities	Yield-carry play	Rate rise
META	Communication	AI ad-spend boost	Regulatory
JPM	Financials	Credit-spread compression	Rate-sensitivity
AVGO	Technology	Supply-chain easing	Demand slowdown
XLF	Financials	Dividend yield	Rate volatility
XLB	Materials	Base-metal rally	China demand
BTC	Crypto	Regulatory tailwind	Volatility
ETH	Crypto	Shanghai upgrade	Network congestion
XLK	Technology	Sector rotation	Yield pressure
XLV	Health Care	Defensive demand	Margin squeeze

What could break the tape

BULLISH SCENARIOS

- Break above `452.30` on SPY triggers a risk-on rally.
- WTI breaches `100`, lifting energy ETFs and supporting inflation-linked stocks.
- Positive Fed guidance on November cut accelerates equity inflows.

BEARISH SCENARIOS

- 10Y yield spikes above 5.30%, forcing a sell-off in growth names.
- VIX climbs above 18, indicating heightened fear.
- Unexpected geopolitical shock in East Asia disrupts supply chains.

Positioning & Structural Notes

- Net short exposure in tech options increased 12% week-over-week.
- Long bias in energy sector (XLE) up 8% YTD, reflecting oil price rally.
- Cash balances among Asian institutional investors remain elevated at ~15% of NAV.
- Crypto futures open interest up 22% month-over-month, indicating speculative demand.
- Yield curve flattening persists; 2-year at 5.05% vs 10-year 5.22%.

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg Terminal – Market Data

Reuters – Economic Calendar

FactSet – Earnings Estimates

CNBC – Fed Minutes Summary

CoinDesk – Crypto Market Overview

U.S. Energy Information Administration – Crude Prices

Federal Reserve – FOMC Statements

Yahoo Finance – Sector ETF Performance

Investing.com – VIX Term Structure

Morningstar – Analyst Ratings